Sudoku Variants

Every logo concept so far: 437 designs over 8 rounds.

Round 1	First three concepts (#A-C)	3 concepts	p. 2
Round 2	Six more	6 concepts	p. 3
Round 3	Emblem, monogram, lettering	6 concepts	p. 5
Round 4	Twelve more, incl. wordmarks	12 concepts	p. 7
Round 5	100 symbols, #28-#127	100 concepts	p. 11
Round 6	Double meanings	6 concepts	p. 15
Round 7	Nine Smile (your idea), smile fixed	4 versions	p. 17
Round 8	60 ideas x 5 styles, #128-#187	300 logos	p. 19

Concepts are black and white first, as the logo-design skill recommends; Round 8 adds colour (the game's blue #2a4fff and gold #e8a020). Small copies on each sheet are shown at true 64/32/16 px. Pick numbers or names and the full logo kit can be built for the chosen one.

Sudoku Variants - logo concepts

Concepts for review — pick a direction (or tell me what you like in each).



A · S-Thermo

RECOMMENDED

A sudoku thermometer that writes the S of Sudoku.



B · The Twist

Nine cells, one turned: same sudoku, one new rule.



C · The Cage

A killer cage with its total tucked in the corner.

Sudoku Variants - more concepts (1/2)

Concepts for review — pick a direction (or tell me what you like in each).



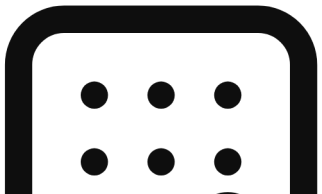




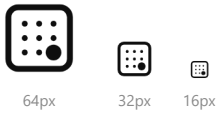
64px 32px 16px

A · V-Clue

The serif V of Variants sits on a cell border like an XV clue.





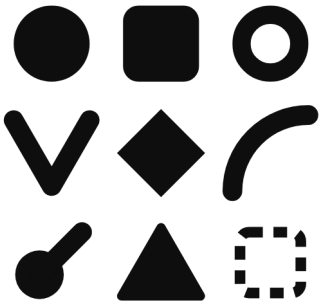


64px 32px 16px

B · Candidates

RECOMMENDED

Nine pencil marks; the 9 spot has grown into the answer.







64px 32px 16px

C · Nine Rules

Nine clue marks, one per variant family.

Sudoku Variants - more concepts (2/2)

Concepts for review — pick a direction (or tell me what you like in each).

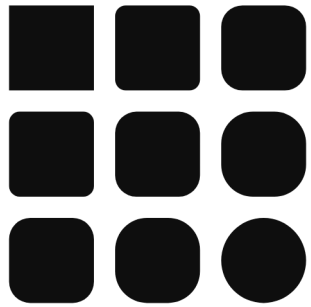






A · Nine-Cell

A 9 whose head is a sudoku cell.



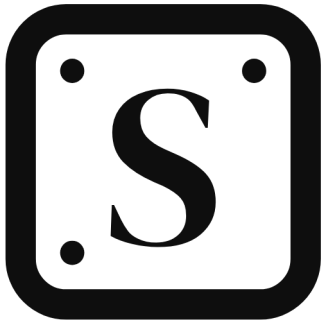




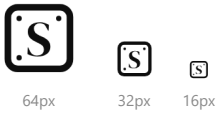
B · Morph

RECOMMENDED

Nine cells turn from square to circle: one cell, nine variations.







C · Given S

One cell with a serif S as its given and pencil marks in the corners.

Sudoku Variants - round 3 (1/2)

Concepts for review — pick a direction (or tell me what you like in each).







64px 32px 16px

A · Seal

RECOMMENDED

A round emblem: the name around the ring, nine cells in the middle.



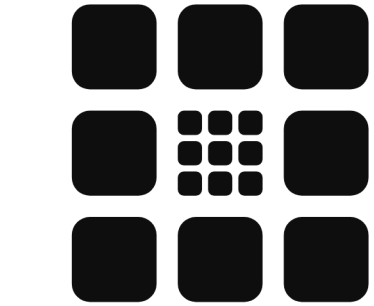




64px 32px 16px

B · SV Monogram

A serif S woven through the V, like a book-cover monogram.







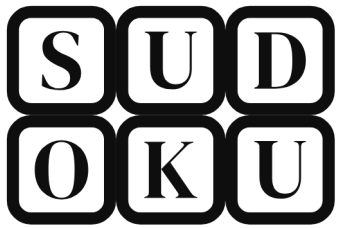
64px 32px 16px

C · Box in Box

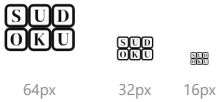
Nine cells; the middle one is itself a grid.

Sudoku Variants - round 3 (2/2)

Concepts for review — pick a direction (or tell me what you like in each).







A · Letter Cells

SUDOKU set as givens in a 3x2 block of cells.





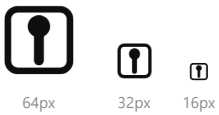


B · Jigsaw Pieces

One box cut into three jigsaw regions.







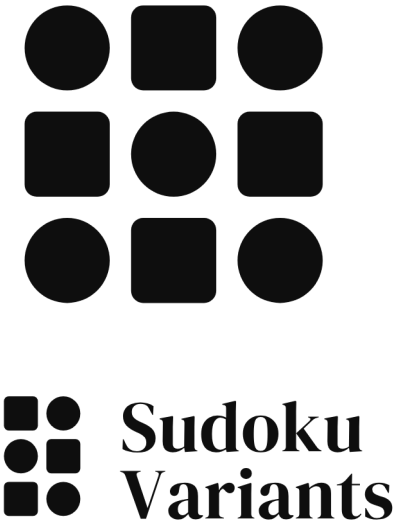
C · Thermo-i

RECOMMENDED

The i of Variants is a sudoku thermometer; alone it's also a keyhole.

Sudoku Variants - round 4 (1/4)

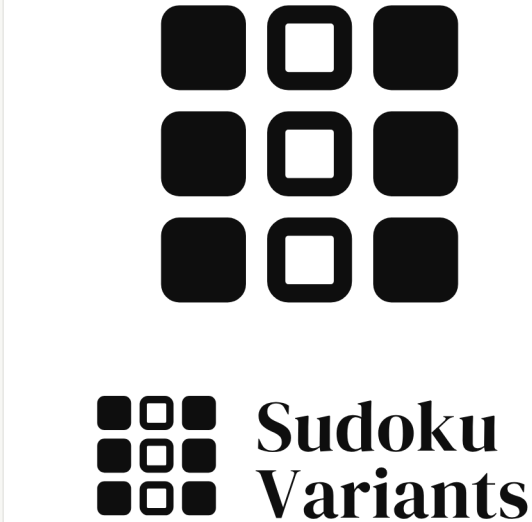
Concepts for review — pick a direction (or tell me what you like in each).



A · Even & Odd

RECOMMENDED

Circles and squares from the even/odd variant, in a checkerboard.



B · Sandwich

Solid outer columns hold an open middle: what you solve is in between.



C · Kropki Cat

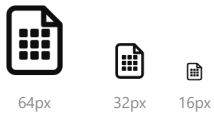
A cat whose eyes are a white and a black kropki dot.

Sudoku Variants - round 4 (2/4)

Concepts for review — pick a direction (or tell me what you like in each).

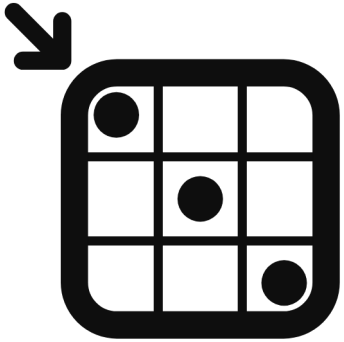




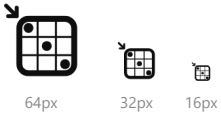


A · Puzzle Page

A sheet of paper with a folded corner and a small grid.

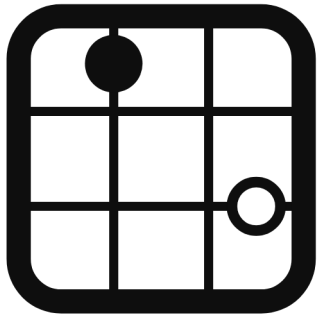




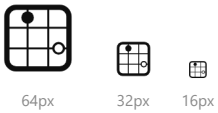


B · Little Killer

An outside arrow points down the diagonal of the grid.







C · Kropki Grid

RECOMMENDED

A 3x3 grid with one black and one white kropki dot on its lines.

Sudoku Variants - round 4 (3/4)

Concepts for review — pick a direction (or tell me what you like in each).



A · O-Cell

The o in Sudoku is a cell: a rounded square with serif contrast.



B · Classic Caps

RECOMMENDED

SUDOKU in spaced capitals, a tiny grid between two rules, VARIANTS below.



C · Modern Sans

Lowercase DM Sans Bold, the i-dot is a diamond; icon = sv on a tile.

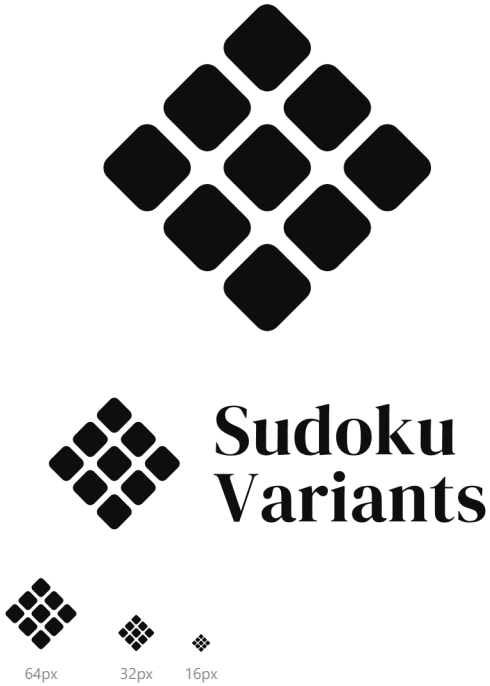
Sudoku Variants - round 4 (4/4)

Concepts for review — pick a direction (or tell me what you like in each).



A · Spiral Thermo

A thermometer that starts in the centre cell and spirals out.



B · Diamond

RECOMMENDED

The 3x3 block turned 45 degrees: sudoku from a new angle.



C · Overlap

Two cells overlap; the shared square is cut out.

Sudoku Variants - round 5 (1/4)

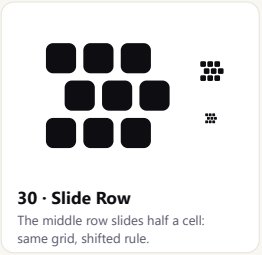
Symbols only; each pairs with the Sudoku Variants wordmark. Small copies at true 32 px and 16 px.



28 · Missing Tile
Eight cells and one gap: the cell you're about to solve.



29 · Lifted Tile
One cell lifts out of the grid, like a digit being placed.



30 · Slide Row
The middle row slides half a cell: same grid, shifted rule.



31 · Growing Tiles
Cells grow from small to large across the block.



32 · Squircle Split
One rounded square cut into nine cells.



33 · Disc Grid
A circle cut into nine cells by the grid lines.



34 · Ring Centre
Eight cells around a ring: the centre is the open question.



35 · Checker Outline
Solid and open cells alternate, givens and blanks.



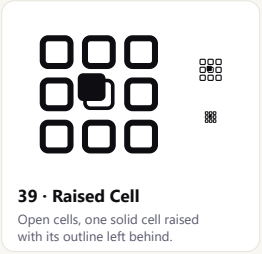
36 · L Selection
An L of selected cells, like a multi-select in the game.



37 · One to Nine
Nine dots sized 1 to 9 in reading order.



38 · Tally Nine
Nine tally strokes in three groups of three.



39 · Raised Cell
Open cells, one solid cell raised with its outline left behind.



40 · Turning Tiles
Each cell turns a little more: nine steps of a variation.



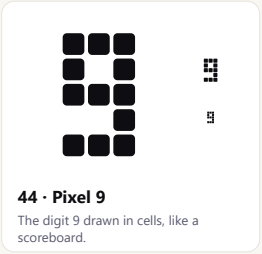
41 · Stencil Grid
A solid plate with nine cell windows punched out.



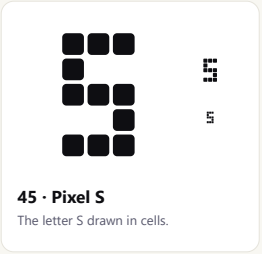
42 · Punch Card
Nine windows in a plate; the centre one is round.



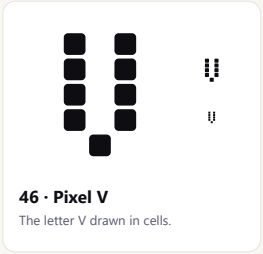
43 · Linked Cells
Nine cells joined by bridges along the path of an S.



44 · Pixel 9
The digit 9 drawn in cells, like a scoreboard.



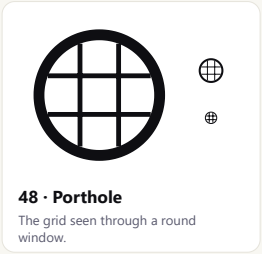
45 · Pixel S
The letter S drawn in cells.



46 · Pixel V
The letter V drawn in cells.



47 · Diagonal Fill
The main diagonal is solid: the diagonal-sudoku rule.



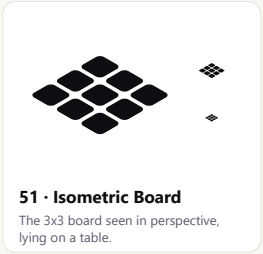
48 · Porthole
The grid seen through a round window.



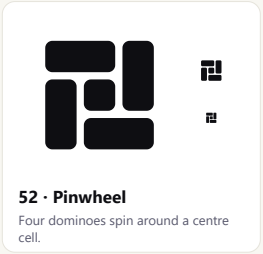
49 · Tri-Grid
A triangle cut into nine smaller triangles.



50 · Honeycomb
Nine hexagon cells: sudoku on a honeycomb.



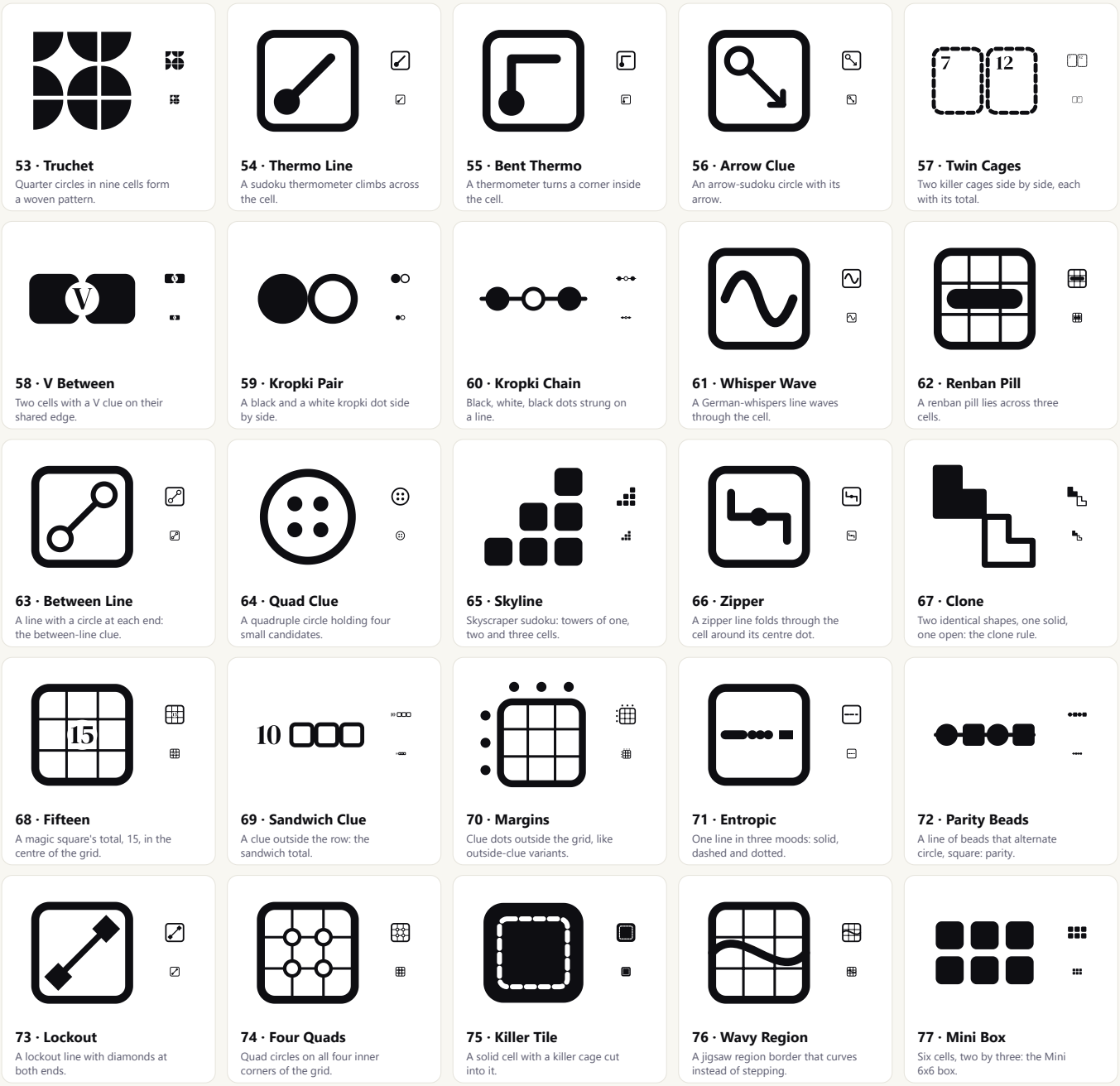
51 · Isometric Board
The 3x3 board seen in perspective, lying on a table.



52 · Pinwheel
Four dominoes spin around a centre cell.

Sudoku Variants - round 5 (2/4)

Symbols only; each pairs with the Sudoku Variants wordmark. Small copies at true 32 px and 16 px.



53 · Truchet
Quarter circles in nine cells form a woven pattern.

54 · Thermo Line
A sudoku thermometer climbs across the cell.

55 · Bent Thermo
A thermometer turns a corner inside the cell.

56 · Arrow Clue
An arrow-sudoku circle with its arrow.

57 · Twin Cages
Two killer cages side by side, each with its total.

58 · V Between
Two cells with a V clue on their shared edge.

59 · Kropki Pair
A black and a white kropki dot side by side.

60 · Kropki Chain
Black, white, black dots strung on a line.

61 · Whisper Wave
A German-whispers line waves through the cell.

62 · Renban Pill
A renban pill lies across three cells.

63 · Between Line
A line with a circle at each end: the between-line clue.

64 · Quad Clue
A quadruple circle holding four small candidates.

65 · Skyline
Skyscraper sudoku: towers of one, two and three cells.

66 · Zipper
A zipper line folds through the cell around its centre dot.

67 · Clone
Two identical shapes, one solid, one open: the clone rule.

68 · Fifteen
A magic square's total, 15, in the centre of the grid.

69 · Sandwich Clue
A clue outside the row: the sandwich total.

70 · Margins
Clue dots outside the grid, like outside-clue variants.

71 · Entropic
One line in three moods: solid, dashed and dotted.

72 · Parity Beads
A line of beads that alternate circle, square: parity.

73 · Lockout
A lockout line with diamonds at both ends.

74 · Four Quads
Quad circles on all four inner corners of the grid.

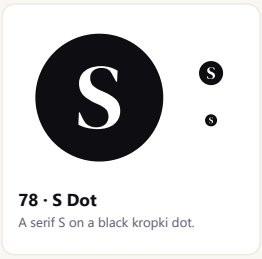
75 · Killer Tile
A solid cell with a killer cage cut into it.

76 · Wavy Region
A jigsaw region border that curves instead of stepping.

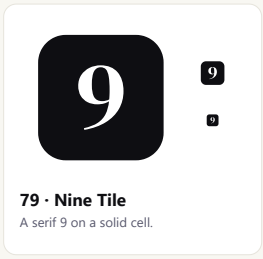
77 · Mini Box
Six cells, two by three: the Mini 6x6 box.

Sudoku Variants - round 5 (3/4)

Symbols only; each pairs with the Sudoku Variants wordmark. Small copies at true 32 px and 16 px.



78 · S Dot
A serif S on a black kropki dot.



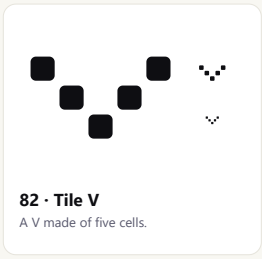
79 · Nine Tile
A serif 9 on a solid cell.



80 · Keypad
The digits 1 to 9 in a 3x3, set in the game's serif.



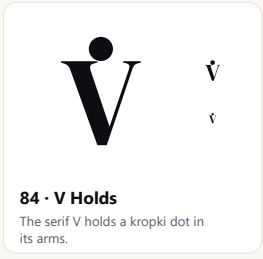
81 · Segment S
An S built from display segments; it also reads as 5.



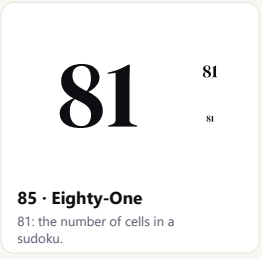
82 · Tile V
A V made of five cells.



83 · Stencil SV
Bold SV with a stencil cut through the middle.



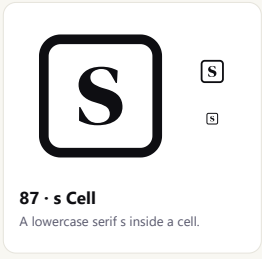
84 · V Holds
The serif V holds a kropki dot in its arms.



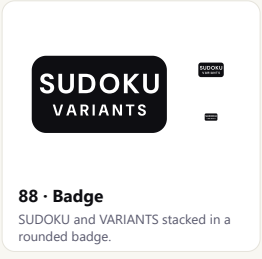
85 · Eighty-One
81: the number of cells in a sudoku.



86 · One-Nine Pill
The digits you play, 1-9, in a pill.



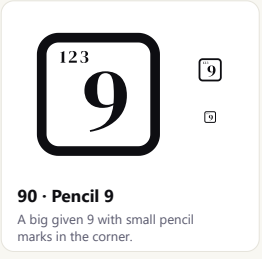
87 · s Cell
A lowercase serif s inside a cell.



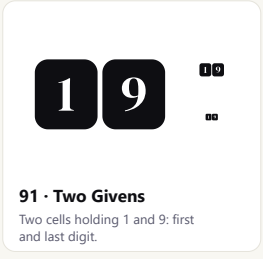
88 · Badge
SUDOKU and VARIANTS stacked in a rounded badge.



89 · S9
S and 9 side by side: Sudoku, nine by nine.



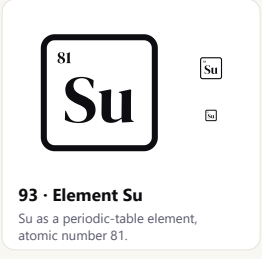
90 · Pencil 9
A big given 9 with small pencil marks in the corner.



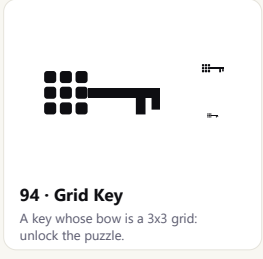
91 · Two Givens
Two cells holding 1 and 9: first and last digit.



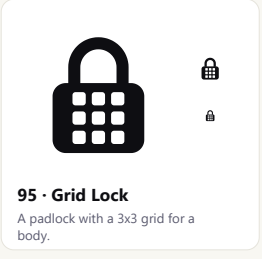
92 · SV Stack
S stacked over V, tight and narrow.



93 · Element Su
Su as a periodic-table element, atomic number 81.



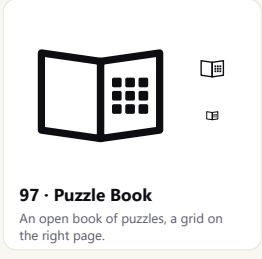
94 · Grid Key
A key whose bow is a 3x3 grid: unlock the puzzle.



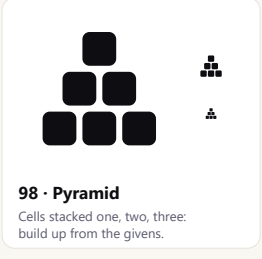
95 · Grid Lock
A padlock with a 3x3 grid for a body.



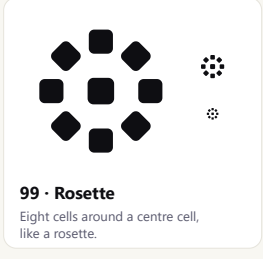
96 · Crown
A crown for the anti-king rule.



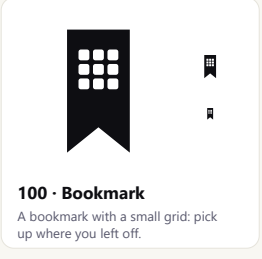
97 · Puzzle Book
An open book of puzzles, a grid on the right page.



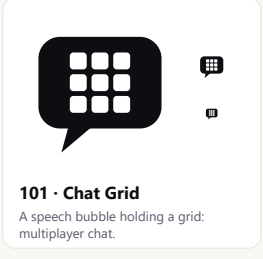
98 · Pyramid
Cells stacked one, two, three: build up from the givens.



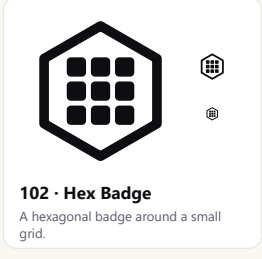
99 · Rosette
Eight cells around a centre cell, like a rosette.



100 · Bookmark
A bookmark with a small grid: pick up where you left off.



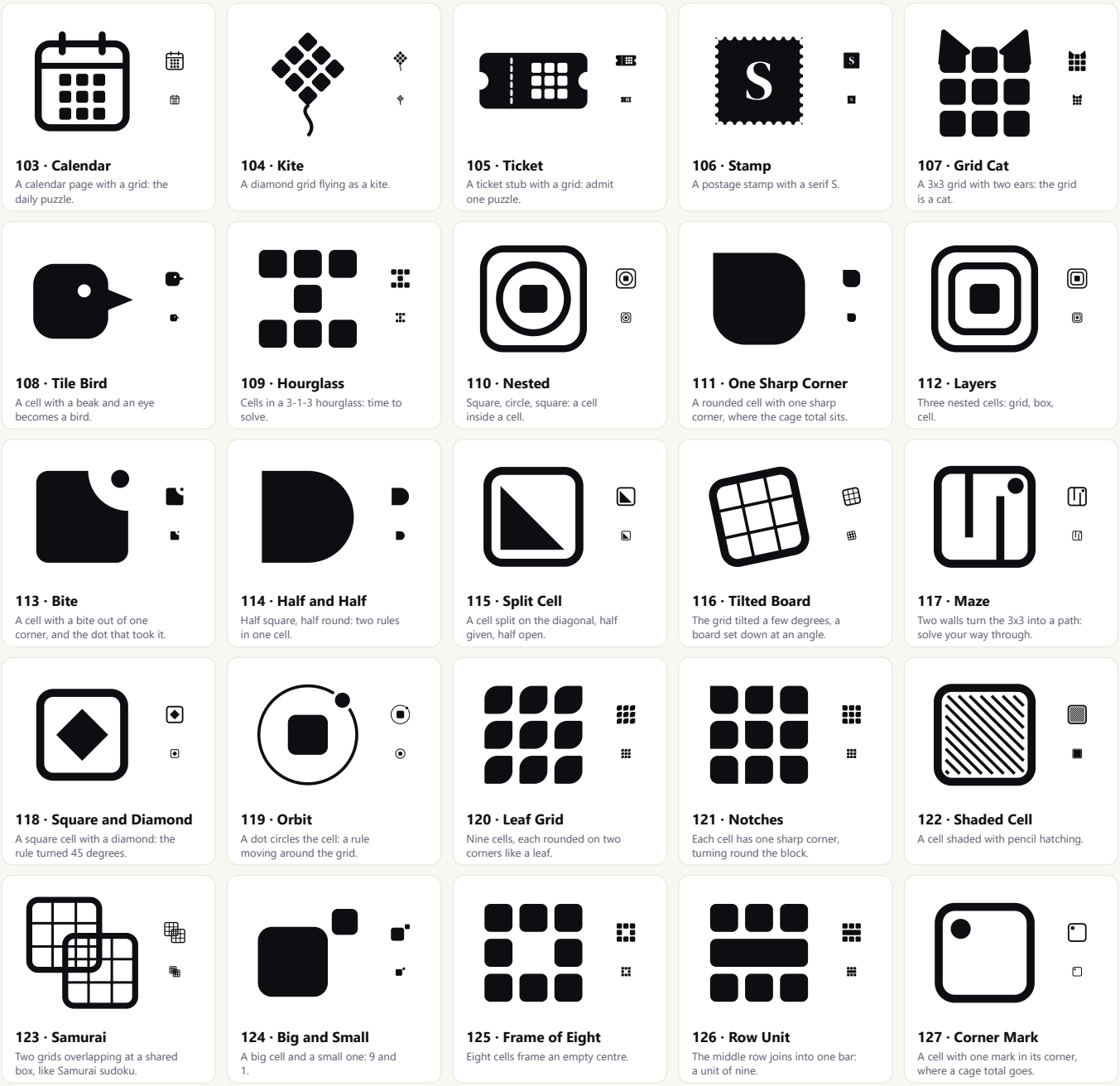
101 · Chat Grid
A speech bubble holding a grid: multiplayer chat.



102 · Hex Badge
A hexagonal badge around a small grid.

Sudoku Variants - round 5 (4/4)

Symbols only; each pairs with the Sudoku Variants wordmark. Small copies at true 32 px and 16 px.



103 · Calendar
A calendar page with a grid: the daily puzzle.

104 · Kite
A diamond grid flying as a kite.

105 · Ticket
A ticket stub with a grid: admit one puzzle.

106 · Stamp
A postage stamp with a serif S.

107 · Grid Cat
A 3x3 grid with two ears: the grid is a cat.

108 · Tile Bird
A cell with a beak and an eye becomes a bird.

109 · Hourglass
Cells in a 3-1-3 hourglass: time to solve.

110 · Nested
Square, circle, square: a cell inside a cell.

111 · One Sharp Corner
A rounded cell with one sharp corner, where the cage total sits.

112 · Layers
Three nested cells: grid, box, cell.

113 · Bite
A cell with a bite out of one corner, and the dot that took it.

114 · Half and Half
Half square, half round: two rules in one cell.

115 · Split Cell
A cell split on the diagonal, half given, half open.

116 · Tilted Board
The grid tilted a few degrees, a board set down at an angle.

117 · Maze
Two walls turn the 3x3 into a path: solve your way through.

118 · Square and Diamond
A square cell with a diamond: the rule turned 45 degrees.

119 · Orbit
A dot circles the cell: a rule moving around the grid.

120 · Leaf Grid
Nine cells, each rounded on two corners like a leaf.

121 · Notches
Each cell has one sharp corner, turning round the block.

122 · Shaded Cell
A cell shaded with pencil hatching.

123 · Samurai
Two grids overlapping at a shared box, like Samurai sudoku.

124 · Big and Small
A big cell and a small one: 9 and 1.

125 · Frame of Eight
Eight cells frame an empty centre.

126 · Row Unit
The middle row joins into one bar: a unit of nine.

127 · Corner Mark
A cell with one mark in its corner, where a cage total goes.

Sudoku Variants - double meanings (1/2)

Concepts for review — pick a direction (or tell me what you like in each).





64px 32px 16px

A · Arrow-9

RECOMMENDED

Reads as: the digit 9 / an arrow-sudoku clue / an undo arrow.





64px 32px 16px

B · Check-V

Reads as: V for Variants / a tick for solved.





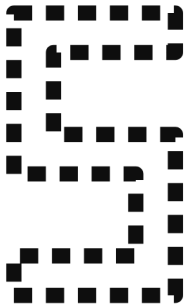
64px 32px 16px

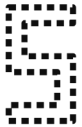
C · Question Thermo

Reads as: ? (a puzzle) / a sudoku thermometer / a kropki dot.

Sudoku Variants - double meanings (2/2)

Concepts for review — pick a direction (or tell me what you like in each).





Sudoku Variants

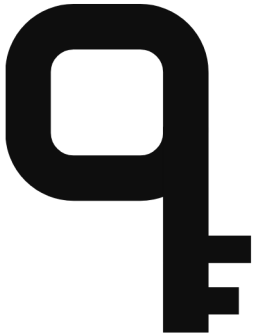


64px 32px 16px

A · S-Cage

RECOMMENDED

Reads as: S for Sudoku / 5 / a killer cage.





Sudoku Variants



64px 32px 16px

B · Nine-Key

Reads as: the digit 9 / a key (unlock the puzzle).





Sudoku Variants



64px 32px 16px

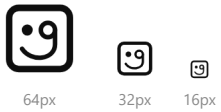
C · Smile Cell

Reads as: a face / a cell with kropki dots and a whisper line.

Nine Smile - smile fix

Concepts for review — pick a direction (or tell me what you like in each).

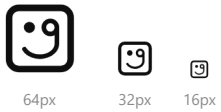




A · Before

Smile hung off the 9: low on the right, a smirk.





B · After

RECOMMENDED

Smile centred under both eyes; the 9's stem flows into it.

Sudoku Variants - Nine Smile (fixed smile)

Concepts for review — pick a direction (or tell me what you like in each).



A · Nine Smile

RECOMMENDED

A cell with a face: left eye a kropki dot, right eye a 9 whose tail is the smile.



B · Nine Smile Tile

The same face on a solid tile: the Steam and app icon.



C · Nine Smile, white dot

Left eye a white kropki dot, echoing the ring of the 9.



D · Nine Smile, no cell

Just the face, no cell: the lightest version.

Sudoku Variants - round 8 (1/6)

Each idea in 5 styles (a-e). Right: the ink tile at true 32 px and 16 px.

a · ink | b · in a cell | c · ink tile | d · blue tile | e · gold badge

128 · Nine Smile

The face you liked: the right eye is a 9 and its tail is the smile.



129 · Nine Wink

The same face, winking: the left eye closes.



130 · Nine Grin

A big open grin hanging from the 9.



131 · Nine Cat

The Nine Smile with cat ears.



132 · Nine Bot

A robot: square eyes, the right one a square 9 whose tail is the mouth.



133 · Nine Bubble

The Nine Smile inside a speech bubble: chat with your rival.



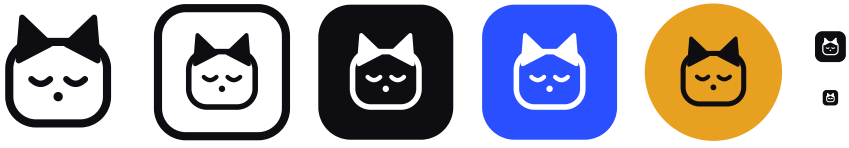
134 · Peek

Two kropki-dot eyes peek over a wall of cells.



135 · Sleepy Cat

A cat-cell with closed eyes, dozing over a puzzle.



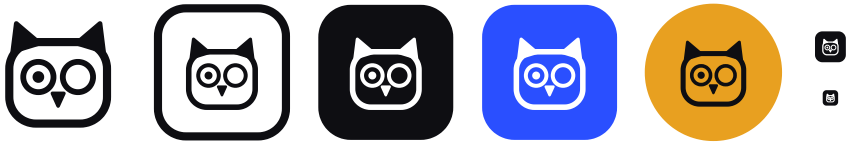
136 · Bunny

A cell with two long ears.



137 · Owl

Kropki eyes, one black, one white, on a wise owl.



Sudoku Variants - round 8 (2/6)

Each idea in 5 styles (a-e). Right: the ink tile at true 32 px and 16 px.

a · ink | b · in a cell | c · ink tile | d · blue tile | e · gold badge

138 · Bear

A bear-cell with round ears.



139 · Frog

A frog: two eye bumps and a wide smile.



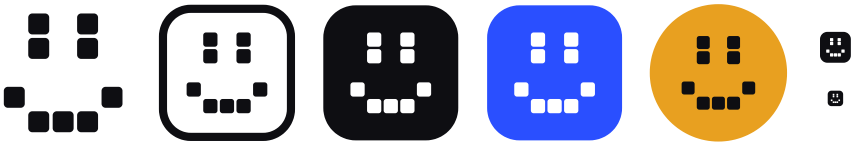
140 · V Fox

A fox face whose shape is a V.



141 · Pixel Smile

A smiley face drawn in cells.



142 · Hatchling

A chick breaking out of a cracked egg: a fresh puzzle.



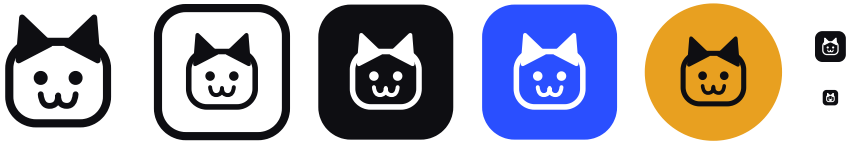
143 · Eight Glasses

A sideways 8 becomes a pair of glasses.



144 · Three Cat

A cat whose mouth is a sideways 3.



145 · Four Boat

The digit 4 is the sail and mast of a boat.



146 · Six Snail

A snail whose shell is a 6: slow and steady.



147 · Two Swan

The digit 2 is a swan on the water.



Sudoku Variants - round 8 (3/6)

Each idea in 5 styles (a-e). Right: the ink tile at true 32 px and 16 px.

a · ink | b · in a cell | c · ink tile | d · blue tile | e · gold badge

148 · One Pencil

The digit 1 is a pencil, for your notes.



149 · Nine Balloon

A 9 whose head is a balloon and whose tail is the string.



150 · Eight Snowman

An 8 dressed as a snowman.



151 · One Candle

The digit 1 as a candle, lighting up the puzzle.



152 · V Gull

A V that is also a gull in flight.



153 · V Heart

A heart whose point is a V.



154 · S Snake

An S that is also a snake.



155 · S Yin-Yang

An S splits a circle; the two small dots are a black and a white kropki dot.



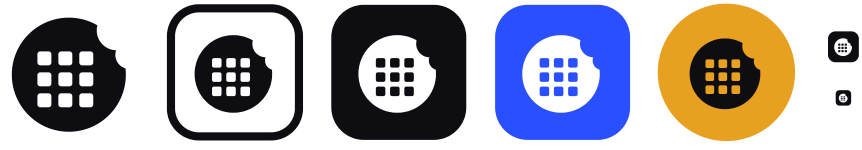
156 · Grid House

A house with a sudoku window: the home of puzzles.



157 · Grid Cookie

A waffle cookie with a bite taken out.



Sudoku Variants - round 8 (4/6)

Each idea in 5 styles (a-e). Right: the ink tile at true 32 px and 16 px.

a · ink | b · in a cell | c · ink tile | d · blue tile | e · gold badge

158 · Grid Gift

A grid wrapped as a present: a new puzzle every day.



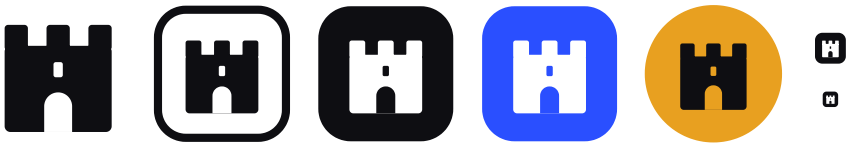
159 · Chocolate

A chocolate bar of cells with one piece broken off.



160 · Fortress

Cells stacked into a castle: the fortress variant.



161 · Lollipop

A thermometer that is also a lollipop.



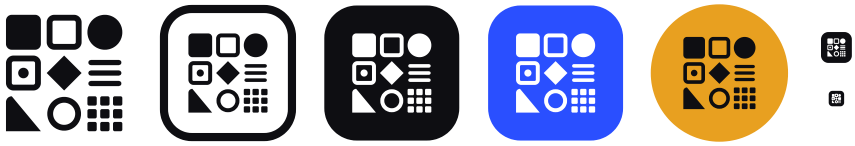
162 · Kropki Paw

A paw print whose toes are black and white kropki dots.



163 · Patchwork

Nine cells, nine different patterns: one grid, many variants.



164 · Steam S Mug

A mug whose steam curls into an S: a puzzle with your morning coffee.



165 · Grid Glasses

Glasses with a sudoku grid in each lens.



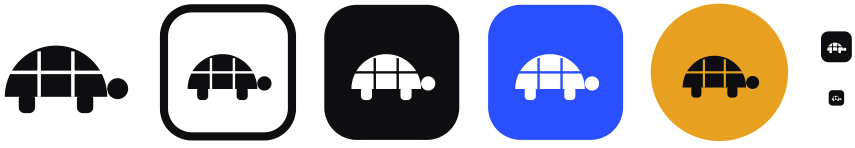
166 · Trophy

A trophy with a grid on its cup: achievements.



167 · Grid Turtle

A turtle with a sudoku grid on its shell.



Sudoku Variants - round 8 (5/6)

Each idea in 5 styles (a-e). Right: the ink tile at true 32 px and 16 px.

a · ink | b · in a cell | c · ink tile | d · blue tile | e · gold badge

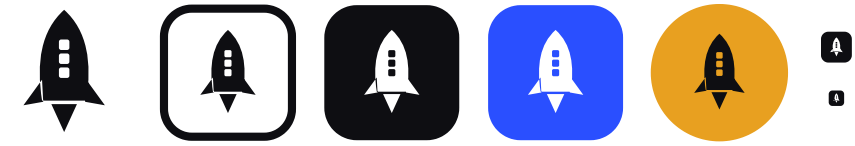
168 · Kropki Ladybug

A ladybug whose spots are kropki dots.



169 · Rocket

A rocket with cell windows: blast through the levels.



170 · Grid Balloon

A hot-air balloon painted with a grid.



171 · V Cone

An ice-cream cone (a V) with a kropki-dot scoop.



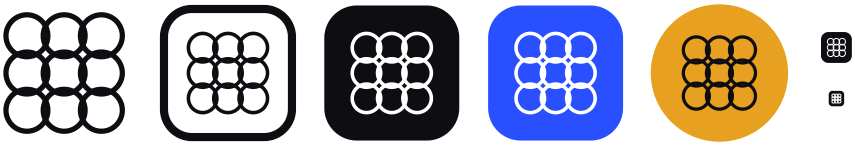
172 · Whirl

Nested squares turning inward: a puzzle that pulls you in.



173 · Rings

Nine linked rings in a 3x3: every cell connects.



174 · Puzzle Box

A box whose lid is a 3x3 grid.



175 · Lock Ls

Two pieces lock into one square: an L and a box.



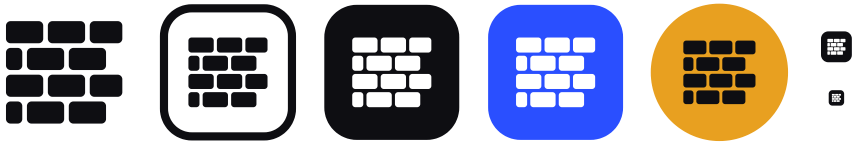
176 · Mondrian

A square cut into uneven regions, solid and open: jigsaw regions.



177 · Bricks

Cells laid like bricks: build the solution one digit at a time.



Sudoku Variants - round 8 (6/6)

Each idea in 5 styles (a-e). Right: the ink tile at true 32 px and 16 px.

a · ink | b · in a cell | c · ink tile | d · blue tile | e · gold badge

178 · Card Fan

Three puzzle cards fanned out: pick your variant.



179 · Stack

A stack of three cells: many puzzles, one after another.



180 · Pixel Heart

A heart drawn in cells.



181 · Shift

A circle cut into three bands; the middle one slides: a variant.



182 · Thermo Sprout

A branching thermometer that grows like a sprout.



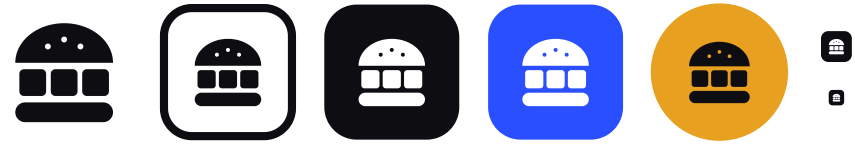
183 · Palindrome

A line that mirrors itself across the middle.



184 · Sandwich Bun

Sandwich sudoku, drawn as an actual sandwich.



185 · Cage Chat

A speech bubble drawn as a killer cage, total in its corner.



186 · V O'Clock

A clock whose hands make a V: the timer.



187 · Zipper

A zipper: the zipper-line variant, closing the puzzle.

